

LittleReads

Chidi's Trip to Space

Science

Ages 7–10

by LittleReads Editorial Team

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One day, the old man said to his family, "I would lie on a mat outside his house and stare up at the sky."

Chapter 1: The Shooting Star

A shooting star streaked across the sky, bright and golden.

"Make a wish!" his father said.

Chidi closed his eyes tight. "I wish I could visit every planet in the solar system."

The shooting star seemed to stop, turn around, and fly straight toward Chidi. A warm, golden light wrapped around him.

When he opened his eyes, he was sitting inside a small, comfortable spacecraft. A friendly robot floated beside him.

"Welcome aboard the Star Explorer!" said the robot. "I am Nova, your guide. You wished to visit the planets. Shall we begin?"

"Is this real?" whispered Chidi.

"As real as the stars themselves," said Nova. "Hold on tight!"

Chapter 2: Mercury and Venus

The Star Explorer zoomed toward the sun, stopping first at Mercury.

"Mercury is the closest planet to the sun," Nova explained. "It is tiny and very hot during the day — up to 430 degrees Celsius! But at night, it is freezing cold."

Chidi peered out the window at the grey, cratered surface. "It looks like the moon," he said.

"Good observation! Mercury has no atmosphere to protect it, so it is covered in craters from meteorite impacts."

They flew on to Venus.

"Venus is sometimes called Earth's twin because it is almost the same size. But do not be fooled — Venus has a thick, poisonous atmosphere and is the hottest planet in our solar system, even hotter than Mercury!"

"Wow," said Chidi. "And people want to live on Mars? Venus is closer!"

"Venus is too hostile," said Nova. "Mars is much more promising."

Chapter 3: Earth and Mars

Next, they passed by Earth. Chidi looked down and saw Africa, his home, glowing in the sunlight.

"Earth is special," said Nova. "It is the only planet we know of that has liquid water, breathable air, and life. You should take care of it."

"I will," said Chidi quietly.

Then they arrived at Mars, the Red Planet.

"Mars has the tallest mountain in the solar system — Olympus Mons. It is almost three times the height of Mount Everest!"

Chidi stared at the red landscape. Dusty, dry, and beautiful. "I want to come back here someday," he said. "As a real astronaut."

"Dream big," said Nova. "Mars is waiting."

Chapter 4: The Gas Giants

Beyond Mars lay the gas giants — Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, and Neptune.

Jupiter was enormous. "Jupiter is so big that all the other planets could fit inside it," said Nova.

Chidi saw the Great Red Spot — a storm larger than Earth that had been raging for hundreds of years.

Then came Saturn, with its beautiful rings.

"Saturn's rings are made of ice and rock, some as small as sand and some as big as houses," Nova explained.

Uranus rolled on its side like a lazy ball, and Neptune shone bright blue, the farthest planet from the sun.

"Neptune has the fastest winds in the solar system — over 2,000 kilometres per hour!" said Nova.

"Everything is so different," said Chidi. "Every planet is unique."

"That is the beauty of our solar system," said Nova. "Each world tells its own story."

Chapter 5: Coming Home

The Star Explorer turned back toward Earth. Chidi was sad to leave the planets but excited to go home.

"Nova, will I remember this?"

"You will remember the feeling," said Nova. "And that feeling will inspire you to learn more, study hard, and chase your dream."

The golden light wrapped around Chidi again, and when he opened his eyes, he was lying on his mat outside his house, looking up at the stars.

His father was beside him, smiling. "You fell asleep while stargazing. Did you dream of anything special?"

Chidi looked at the sky — at Mars, a tiny red dot, and Saturn, barely visible through his telescope.

"I dreamed of the future, Papa. And I am going to make it real."

He went inside and picked up his science book. There was so much to learn. And Chidi was ready.

What We Learned

- Our solar system has eight unique planets, each with special features.
- The sun is the centre of the solar system.
- Earth is special because it supports life.
- Dreaming big and studying hard are the first steps to achieving your goals.

Discussion Questions

1. Which planet would you most like to visit? Why?
2. What is the difference between a gas giant and a rocky planet?
3. What do you think we need to do to take care of Earth?

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Thank you for reading!

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